TRAVELSCOUT · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Project charter

The agreement on what TravelScout is for, how it is delivered and how it is judged.

PROJECT
TravelScout

PREPARED BY
Aditi Kela, product lead

VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

PROJECT
TravelScout, an AI-powered group trip-planning app CONFIRMED

OWNER
Aditi Kela CONFIRMED

ORIGIN
Started in the Northeastern course on semantic intelligence (INFO 7375) CONFIRMED

STATUS
Working app CONFIRMED

NAME IN THE APP
The browser tab still reads "TripMate AI"; rename to match TO CONFIRM

Purpose

Group trips are planned across chat threads, spreadsheets and links, and prices go stale. TravelScout gives each trip one room. Everyone joins with a trip code, shares budget, interests, pace and dietary needs, and plans together in one chat with an AI travel guide that proposes flights and stays with price estimates, a checked date and a source link. CONFIRMED

Objectives

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE	TARGET	BASIS
1	Deliver the core planning room	Features live: group chat, AI planner, flights and hotels, itinerary, polls, weather	6 of 6	CONFIRMED Met
2	Make price information honest	Share of prices shown with a checked date and a source link	100%	CONFIRMED Met

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE	TARGET	BASIS
3	Capture each traveler's needs	Preference form fields: budget, interests, pace, dietary, accessibility	5 of 5	CONFIRMED Met
4	Test with real groups	Groups that plan a trip end to end	5 groups of 3 to 6 people	PROPOSED
5	Prove the AI guide helps	Travelers who say the guide saved time	At least 70%	PROPOSED
6	Keep AI cost per trip small	Cost per planned trip	Under $1 ESTIMATE	ESTIMATE

Deliverables

- Working app with trip rooms, join codes, group chat and an AI travel guide CONFIRMED
- Flight and hotel estimates labeled with the date checked and a source link CONFIRMED
- Plan, polls, itinerary and expenses tabs CONFIRMED
- Six desktop screenshots for the portfolio CONFIRMED
- Group test report PROPOSED

Roles

WHO	ROLE	BASIS
Aditi Kela	Product, design and build owner	CONFIRMED
Northeastern course INFO 7375	Where the project started	CONFIRMED
Test groups	Plan a real or mock trip and give feedback	PROPOSED

Timeline

Durations are project weeks. The completed phases are my reconstruction of the effort and need correction. TO CONFIRM

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	DURATION	STATUS	BASIS
1. Define	Problem, users, feature list, success criteria	1 week	Complete	ESTIMATE
2. Design	Screens for home, start-a-trip, trip room, preferences	2 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
3. Build core	Trip rooms with join codes, group chat, preferences	3 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
4. Build AI guide	Guide asks questions, proposes flights and stays with estimates, date and source	3 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
5. Build tabs	Itinerary, polls, weather and expenses	2 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
6. Rename and polish	Fix the app name, remove stray characters in chat, tidy copy	1 week	Next	PROPOSED
7. Group tests	5 groups plan a trip; collect feedback	3 weeks	Planned	PROPOSED
8. Improve	Fix top issues; decide on features such as expense splitting depth	3 weeks	Planned	PROPOSED

Risks

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Price estimates are wrong or stale	High	High	Keep the "estimate, verify before booking" label, show the checked date, re-check on open
AI invents a flight or hotel	Medium	High	Only show items that have a source link; hide any result without one
Cost per trip climbs with long chats	Medium	Medium	Use the smaller model for routine replies; cap turns per trip
Groups prefer apps they already use	High	Medium	Make joining one link; import from chat later
Name confusion (TripMate AI versus TravelScout)	High	Low	Rename the app title and tab

Assumptions

- Prices are planning estimates, not booking prices. **CONFIRMED**
- Group trips of 3 to 6 people are the target. **PROPOSED**

Approval

NAME	ROLE	VERSION	DATE
Aditi Kela	Product, design and build owner	1.0, draft for review	October 15, 2026